

going to be that way. I'm still going to be involved. I'm still going to be pushing for new avenues and new spaces for track to reside in, and trying to create new opportunities for the athletes coming behind me. I think that will add to the legacy I created while I was on the track.

You already have a pretty major legacy on the track — four straight world gold medals in the 200m and Olympic 100m champion. That's sizeable.

It's one of those things that comes with the territory. You say you want to be the greatest, you start winning, and all of a sudden you look behind you and see four World Championships gold medals in the 200m, or realise you're the third-fastest man ever and an

Olympic champion.

Earlier this year, I showed up at a WWE event and they said, 'We want you to bring your medals.' And I was like, 'All of them?' And they were like, 'Yeah.'

That was the first time I'd put in that much effort putting them on, and when I started counting, I realised, 'Seven, eight, nine! Goodness, this is going to hurt my neck!' In my head, I know I'm halfway through my career, and I think I've already achieved things that not all the greats have achieved.

A few weeks back, Tyson [Gay] came to the track where I was training and did a bit of coaching. He was joking with my coach and shouting, 'Who's the baddest man in the sport?' I turned around and said, 'You're looking at him.'

You seem to get along pretty well with most of your competitors.

It's a lot easier to get along with the ones who aren't in the USA because I'm usually fighting with the Americans for the three spots at the US trials. But for the most part, I don't think I've ever been enemies with anyone. I feel like I can learn something from anybody, and I enjoy learning from people even if we're not friends.

Christian Coleman is a great example. I studied his start and acceleration very closely. I studied Trayvon Bromell's top-end mechanics. Going further back, I used to study Yohan [Blake] and Justin [Gatlin] because I wanted to know how they perfected their craft. Sprinting is a work of art, and I want to know everything about that story.



Inspiration: I'm now at the age where the new athletes coming through watched me and are now fans. They ask for advice, and I'm almost put into a role-model position in the middle of my career. That's something I really enjoy because I want to see everyone run their best," Noah Lyles.

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